



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

READING INTO WRITING

AI Feedback Workbook

A four-week guided companion for your weekly AI feedback session

The London School of Economics and Political Science

Pre-sessional English for Academic Purposes



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How this workbook works

Every week of the course you write a Reading into Writing practice essay. Your teacher will read it and give you feedback. This workbook adds a second layer: a chance to interrogate your own writing with an AI assistant, in class, while your teacher's comments are fresh. The point is to help you become your own editor and become effective at noticing patterns, checking your work against the criteria, and fixing things yourself.

Your weekly rhythm

1. You write your practice essay in class
2. Your teacher reads it and gives feedback.
3. In the feedback session, you use this workbook and the AI to look again at your essay: general strengths and weaknesses first, then that week's special focus.
4. You evaluate the AI feedback, decide what you agree with, and set targets.
5. You revise your essay and carry your targets into next week.

The Golden Rules for using AI in this course

Read these once and keep them in mind every week. They protect your learning and your academic integrity.

1. You write the essay; the AI only gives feedback. Never ask it to write or rewrite your essay, a paragraph, or even a sentence.
2. Never copy the AI's words into your work. If it suggests wording, evaluate what it suggests. Work out your own improvement. In the assessment, there will be no AI to lean on.
3. The AI is a mirror, not a marker. It helps you see your writing more clearly. It does not give you a real grade, and it does not replace your teacher.
4. The AI can be wrong. It sometimes invents rules, misjudges the level or gives vague advice. Always check what it says against the marking criteria and your teacher's comments.
5. Feedback only counts if you act on it. Every session ends with you revising your own essay and setting targets.
6. Share only your essay and the task materials. Do not paste personal information about yourself or other people.

REMEMBER

A simple test: if the AI has produced text that could go straight into your essay, you have used it the wrong way. Ask it to point, explain and question — not to fix.

Writing prompts that work — and using AI critically

You will get far more useful feedback if you ask precise questions. The prompts in this workbook are written for you to copy, but you should also learn to steer the conversation yourself.

Four moves that improve any prompt

- Give context. Tell the AI it is your writing tutor, that you want feedback (not rewriting), and paste the criteria, the question and your essay first.
- Ask it to highlight, not fix. Use verbs like identify, locate, quote back, explain, compare — not correct, rewrite, improve.
- Ask for evidence. Add: “Quote the exact part of my essay you mean”, so the feedback is about your text, not writing in general.
- Do one thing at a time. Focused questions (“look only at my introduction”) get sharper answers than “is this good?”

Useful follow-up questions

- “Give me a specific example from my essay.” (when the answer is too general)
- “Explain that term with an example.” (when you do not understand)
- “Which part of the marking criteria does this relate to?” (to keep it relevant)
- “Show me what I did well here, not just the problems.”

Staying critical

Treat the AI as a confident colleague who is sometimes mistaken. Before you accept a piece of feedback, ask yourself: does this match the criteria? Does it match what my teacher said? Do I actually understand why? If a suggestion would make you copy the AI's wording, ignore it. You can be right and the AI wrong — trust the criteria and your teacher over the machine.

Something the AI told me this term that I decided NOT to follow (and why):

Understanding the marking criteria

Your Reading into Writing essay is marked on two things at once. Knowing them turns every session into targeted practice rather than guesswork.

Reading — how well you use the source texts: choosing relevant material, synthesising ideas across texts, and paraphrasing, summarising and quoting accurately.

Writing — how well you write the essay: fulfilling the task, structuring your argument, and your language style, range and accuracy.

What each band looks like, in plain language

Band	Reading — strong work...	Writing — strong work...
80+	Uses the texts excellently to support the argument; adapts source content to the purpose; finds common themes and links within and across texts; excellent quoting, paraphrasing and summarising.	Fully answers the question; ideas are very logically sequenced with strong cohesion and paragraphing; wide, precise, flexible range of grammar and vocabulary; almost error-free.
70–75	Very good use of the texts; successfully adapts content to purpose; identifies themes and links across texts; very good quoting, paraphrasing and summarising.	Answers all or most of the task; logical sequencing, wide cohesion, effective paragraphing; good, flexible range; occasional errors that do not strain the reader.
60–65	Good use of the texts; reasonably adapts content; identifies themes and links but tends to be descriptive; reasonable quoting, paraphrasing and summarising.	Meets most of the task; generally clear progression and paragraphing; sufficient range but may lack flexibility, style or precision; errors rarely impede meaning.
50 or below	Some use of the texts but could be improved; not entirely successful at adapting content; links are often only descriptive; some errors in quoting, paraphrasing, summarising.	Does not meet all task requirements; sequencing and paragraphing not always effective; limited range; errors may cause some strain for the reader.

Ask yourself before every session (self-assessment)

- **READING:** Have I used all the relevant texts, or leaned on one? Have I connected ideas across texts, or just described each in turn? Are my paraphrases genuinely in my own words?
- **WRITING:** Am I answering the exact question? Can a reader follow my line of argument from introduction to conclusion? Is my language accurate and varied enough for postgraduate study?



REMEMBER

Notice the word descriptive in the middle bands. Moving up usually means doing less reporting of what the texts say and more analysing, comparing and arguing. Keep this in mind from Week 2 onwards.

Setting up your AI feedback session

Start every session with the setup prompt below. It tells the AI what its job is and gives it everything it needs. Add:

1. The marking criteria (see Moodle)
2. The week's task (see Moodle)
3. Your full essay

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

You are my academic writing tutor. I am an international student preparing for a postgraduate "Reading into Writing" assessment, where I read academic extracts and write an essay in response to a question. I want feedback on MY writing so that I can revise it myself. Very important: do not rewrite my essay and do not write any new sentences for me — point to things, explain them, and ask me questions instead. Here are the marking criteria: [PASTE CRITERIA]. Here is the task: [PASTE TASK]. Here is my essay: [PASTE YOUR ESSAY]. First tell me in one line that you understand, then wait for my next instruction.

Tip: Paste the whole essay, not a paragraph. The AI needs the full text to judge structure and whether you answer the question.

Week 1: What an essay is

This week's focus: Answering the question, introductions, thesis statements and conclusions.

This week is about the frame of your essay. Before worrying about detail, a marker asks a simple question: does this essay actually answer the question, and can I tell what the writer's position is? A strong introduction sets up the topic and states a clear thesis; a strong conclusion returns to the question and pulls the argument together. This week you check that your frame is sound.

By the end of this session you will have...

- Checked that your essay answers the exact question that was asked.
- Tested whether your introduction has a clear, arguable thesis statement.
- Checked that your conclusion answers the question and does not just repeat the introduction.
- Set a baseline of the issues you want to overcome this term.

Part A Before you open the AI

Spend ten minutes with the AI closed. Reread the question, then your essay, then your teacher's feedback.

- Underline the key words in the essay question. What exactly are you being asked to do?
- Read only your introduction and predict: is my position (thesis) clear here?
- Read only your conclusion: does it answer the question?

Your prediction — where you think this essay is strong, and where it is weak:

Part B General strengths and weaknesses

Run your setup prompt first. Then use these prompts to get an overall picture before you narrow down to this week's focus.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Give me feedback on my essay using the two areas in the criteria (Reading and Writing). For each area, tell me two things I do well and two things to improve, and quote the exact part of my essay you are talking about each time. Do not rewrite anything.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Guess the band my essay would fall into for Reading and for Writing and explain your reasoning using the criteria. I know this is only an estimate, not a real mark.

In your own words, list:

Two strengths

- 1.
- 2.

Two things to work on

- 1.
- 2.

Part C This week's focus — the essay's frame

Now examine the frame of your essay one piece at a time.

1. Are you answering the question?

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Look at my essay against the essay question. Do I answer the question? Underline (by quoting back to me) the parts where I clearly answer the question, and the parts where I drift off-topic or answer a different question. Do not fix anything.

Do you answer the question directly? If not, how can you improve?

2. Your thesis statement

A thesis statement tells the reader your position and previews how you will argue it.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Find my thesis statement and quote it back to me exactly. Tell me whether it (a) states a clear position and (b) previews my argument. Could it be improved in any way? Do not write a new thesis for me.

Tip: If the AI cannot find a thesis, that is your finding: you may not have one yet.

Do you have a thesis statement? If so, how effective is it? Is anything missing?

3. Introduction

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Look at my introduction. Is it an appropriate length for my essay (approximately 10% of the total word count or less)? Does it clearly introduce the topic and present a focused thesis or position that answers the essay question? Identify any areas that could be improved and suggest specific revisions.

What, if anything, does your introduction need to do differently?

4. Conclusion

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Look at my conclusion. Is it an appropriate length for my essay (approximately 10% of the total word count or less)? Does it clearly restate and reinforce my answer to the essay question without introducing new arguments or evidence? Identify any areas that could be improved.

What, if anything, does your conclusion need to do differently?

5. Introduction and conclusion working together

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Compare my introduction and conclusion. Identify the main argument or position in each and explain whether they are aligned. Does the conclusion return to the essay question and effectively synthesise the argument, or does it mainly repeat the introduction or introduce new ideas? Give specific examples and suggest improvements.

Do I need to do anything differently?

Part D Language check

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Evaluate the range, accuracy, and academic style of the language in my essay. Identify strengths and weaknesses in my vocabulary and grammar and suggest specific improvements to make my writing more precise, varied, and appropriate for an academic audience.

Do I need to do anything differently?

Part E Revise and set targets

Review your essay using what you have learned. Identify three improvements you can make to this essay. Then set two targets for next week.

Three specific improvements I can make to THIS essay (I will make them myself, not copy the AI):

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

My two targets for next week

- 1.
- 2.

Week 2: Using sources well

This week's focus: Paraphrasing, summarising, quoting, avoiding plagiarism, and developing a critical voice.

This week, we have focused on using sources. How effectively did you use the texts in your essay? To get high marks, you need to move beyond simply describing sources and instead use them to support your arguments. This means comparing different perspectives, evaluating the strength of evidence, and building your own position from the ideas in the literature. Developing this ability is what gives your writing a critical academic voice.

By the end of this session you will have...

- Located every place you used a source and checked how you used it.
- Found any paraphrases that stay too close to the original (a plagiarism risk).
- Identified where you synthesise sources versus where you only describe them.
- Found where your own critical voice is present — and where it is missing.

Part A Before you open the AI

Have the three extracts for this week's topic open beside you — you will need them to check your paraphrasing.

- Skim your essay and mark every place you refer to a source. Did you use all the texts?
- Which text(s) did you find most helpful?
- Do you have any paragraphs which do not refer to any of the texts?

Also look back to last week's essay. What were the two targets you set?

My two targets:

- 1.
- 2.

Part B General strengths and weaknesses

Run your setup prompt first. Then use these prompts to get an overall picture before you narrow down to this week's focus.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Give me feedback on my essay using the two areas in the criteria (Reading and Writing). For each area, tell me two things I do well and two things to improve, and quote the exact part of my essay you are talking about each time. Do not rewrite anything.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Guess the band my essay would fall into for Reading and for Writing and explain your reasoning using the criteria. I know this is only an estimate, not a real mark.

In your own words, list:

Two strengths

- 1.
- 2.

Two things to work on

- 1.
- 2.

Part C This week's focus — sources and critical voice

1. Using texts

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Find every place I use the source texts. For each one, tell me whether I quoted, paraphrased or summarised, and whether it is clear which source the idea came from. Do I seem to be overly reliant on one text?

Are my sources clearly signalled? Do I rely too much on one text?

2. Paraphrasing

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Point to any phrases where my wording stays too close to the original text and I am at risk of plagiarism. Suggest THREE ways of rewording these phrases.

Phrases that are too close to the source:

3. Synthesis

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Where do I connect ideas across two or more texts (synthesis), and where do I just describe one text?

Are there places where I can link texts together instead of describing them separately?

4. Critical voice

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Show me sentences where I add my own critical voice (evaluating, comparing, questioning) and sentences that only report what a source says. What proportion is only descriptive?

Two places I will add my own analysis or evaluation:

- 1.
- 2.

Part D Language check

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Evaluate the range, accuracy, and academic style of the language in my essay. Identify strengths and weaknesses in my vocabulary and grammar and suggest specific improvements to make my writing more precise, varied, and appropriate for an academic audience.

Do I need to do anything differently?

Part E Progress check

Paste last week's essay and this week's essay into the AI together so it can compare them.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Here is last week's essay: [PASTE]. Here is this week's essay: [PASTE]. Last week I was working on these targets: [WRITE YOUR TWO TARGETS]. Comparing the two essays, am I doing these better now? Point to evidence in both essays. Also tell me if any weakness appears in both — a problem that is not going away.

Tip: This is the most important prompt of the day. Persistent problems are your priority.

Did I hit last week's targets? What is improving, and what keeps coming back?

Now update the Cumulative Progress Tracker at the back of this workbook.

Part F Revise and set targets

Review your essay using what you have learned. Identify three improvements you can make to this essay. Then set two targets for next week.

Three specific improvements I can make to THIS essay (I will make them myself, not copy the AI):

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

My two targets for next week

- 1.
- 2.

Week 3: Structure and argument

This week's focus: Essay structure, topic sentences, concluding sentences and patterns of argument.

A reader should be able to follow your argument from the shape of your paragraphs alone. Each body paragraph should carry one clear idea, announced by a topic sentence and, often, tied off with a concluding sentence. Across the whole essay, the paragraphs should follow a recognisable pattern of argument that suits the question. This week you test the skeleton of your essay.

By the end of this session you will have...

- Checked that every body paragraph has a clear topic sentence and one main idea.
- Mapped the function of each paragraph and how they connect.
- Identified your overall pattern of argument and whether it fits the question.
- Found where the logic jumps or where paragraphs overlap.

Part A Before you open the AI

Read only the first sentence of each paragraph of your essay, in order, and nothing else.

- From those first sentences alone, can you follow your whole argument? If not, your topic sentences need work.
- Do any two paragraphs seem to cover the same idea?
- Does the order of your paragraphs feel deliberate, or accidental?

Because you have written before, also look back:

- Reread last week's essay and the two targets you set at the end of it.
- Write those two targets here so you can check them later today.

My two targets:

- 1.
- 2.

Part B General strengths and weaknesses

Run your setup prompt first. Then use these prompts to get an overall picture before you narrow down to this week's focus.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Give me feedback on my essay using the two areas in the criteria (Reading and Writing). For each area, tell me two things I do well and two things to improve, and quote the exact part of my essay you are talking about each time. Do not rewrite anything.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Guess the band my essay would fall into for Reading and for Writing and explain your reasoning using the criteria. I know this is only an estimate, not a real mark.

In your own words, list:

Two strengths

- 1.
- 2.

Two things to work on

- 1.
- 2.

Part C This week's focus — structure and argument

Examine the skeleton of your essay — paragraphs, topic sentences and the shape of the argument.

1. Topic sentences

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

For each body paragraph, quote the first sentence and tell me whether it works as a topic sentence that signals one clear idea. List any paragraph that has no clear topic sentence or that contains more than one main idea. Do not rewrite them.

Paragraphs that need a clearer topic sentence:

2. Map the essay

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

In a short list, tell me the function of each paragraph (what job it does in my argument) and how it connects to the one before it. Point to any place where the logic jumps or

where two paragraphs overlap.

Tip: Ask a follow-up: “Would you move any paragraphs? If so, why?”

My paragraph plan, and one change I will make to the order or content:

3. Concluding sentences and cohesion

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

*Do my paragraphs end in a way that links to the next idea, or do they stop abruptly?
Show me two paragraphs whose links to the next paragraph are weak.*

Where I need better links between paragraphs:

4. Pattern of argument

Common patterns include problem–solution, cause–and–effect, for-and-against, and comparison.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

What overall pattern of argument does my essay use, and is it consistent and appropriate for this question? Where does my line of argument become hard to follow?

My pattern of argument, and whether it suits the question:

Part D Progress check

Time to check whether you are actually improving. Paste last week's essay and this week's essay into the AI together so it can compare them.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Here is last week's essay: [PASTE]. Here is this week's essay: [PASTE]. Last week I was working on these targets: [WRITE YOUR TWO TARGETS]. Comparing the two essays, am I doing these better now? Point to evidence in both essays. Also tell me if any weakness appears in both — a problem that is not going away.

Tip: This is the most important prompt of the day. Persistent problems are your priority

Did I hit last week's targets? What is improving, and what keeps coming back?

Now update the Cumulative Progress Tracker at the back of this workbook.

Part Revise and set targets

Review your essay using what you have learned. Identify three improvements you can make to this essay. Then set two targets for next week.

Three specific changes I will make to THIS essay (I will make them myself, not copy the AI):

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

My two targets for next week

- 1.
- 2.

Week 4: Polishing language

This week's focus: Accuracy, range, stylistic choices and writing concisely.

By now your ideas, sources and structure should be in good shape. This week is about the surface: reducing errors, widening your range of grammar and vocabulary, making stylistic choices suitable for postgraduate writing, and cutting words that do no work. Small gains here move you up the Writing bands, where the difference between good and excellent is precision and control. This is also the week to look back across all four essays.

By the end of this session you will have...

- Identified your most frequent and most serious error patterns.
- Found sentences that are wordy or repetitive and understood why.
- Spotted where your vocabulary or grammar is repetitive or too simple.
- Checked your progress across the whole term and named any persistent problem.

Part A Before you open the AI

Read your essay aloud quietly, or under your breath. Your ear catches errors and clumsy sentences your eye skips.

- Mark any sentence you stumbled over when reading aloud.
- Find one sentence you think is too long, and one word you have used too many times.
- Recall the error type your teacher mentions most across the term.

Because you have written before, also look back:

- Reread last week's essay and the two targets you set at the end of it
- Write those two targets here so you can check them later today.

My two targets

- 1.
- 2.

Part B General strengths and weaknesses

Run your setup prompt first. Then use these prompts to get an overall picture before you narrow down to this week's focus.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Give me feedback on my essay using the two areas in the criteria (Reading and Writing). For each area, tell me two things I do well and two things to improve, and quote the exact part of my essay you are talking about each time. Do not rewrite anything.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Guess the band my essay would fall into for Reading and for Writing and explain your reasoning using the criteria. I know this is only an estimate, not a real mark.

In your own words, list:

Two strengths

- 1.
- 2.

Two things to work on

- 1.
- 2.

Part C This week's focus — accuracy, range, style and concision

Work on the surface of your writing. Remember Rule 2 more than ever this week: the AI must not correct your sentences — you correct them yourself.

1. Your error patterns

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Identify my five most frequent or most serious language errors (grammar, punctuation, word choice). Group them by type, and for each give me the rule and one example from MY essay. Do not correct the essay — I will correct it myself once I understand the patterns.

Tip: Learning the pattern fixes many sentences at once; a corrected essay fixes none of them in your head.

My top error patterns and the rule for each:

2. Writing concisely

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Point to sentences that are wordy, repetitive, or could be more direct, and explain why each is wordy. Do not rewrite them.

Wordy sentences I will tighten (and how):

3. Range and style

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Where is my vocabulary or sentence structure repetitive or too simple for postgraduate academic writing? Where is my style too informal or otherwise inappropriate? Show me the patterns without rewriting.

Where I will vary my language or adjust my style:

Part D Progress check

Time to check whether you are actually improving. Paste last week's essay and this week's essay into the AI together, so it can compare them.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

Here is last week's essay: [PASTE]. Here is this week's essay: [PASTE]. Last week I was working on these targets: [WRITE YOUR TWO TARGETS]. Comparing the two essays, am I doing these better now? Point to evidence in both essays. Also tell me if any weakness appears in both — a problem that is not going away.

Tip: This is the most important prompt of the day. Persistent problems are your priority.

Did I hit last week's targets? What is improving, and what keeps coming back?

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Part E Revise and set targets

Review your essay using what you have learned. Identify three improvements you can make to this essay. Then set two targets for next week.

Three specific changes I will make to THIS essay (I will make them myself, not copy the AI):

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

My two targets for next week

- 1.
- 2.

Cumulative progress tracker

This is the single most useful page in the workbook. Use it to follow a problem across the whole term. Each week, add any new issues and update the older ones. Your goal is to move issues from the left of the table to “Fixed” on the right. A problem that reappears in three or four columns is where your energy should go.

Issue / weakness	Criteria area	Wk 1	Wk 2	Wk 3	Wk 4	Fixed?
1. Articles	Writing	✓	✓	✓	-	YES
2. Thesis statements	Writing	✓	-	-		NO
3. Synthesis	Reading	-	✓			
4.						
5.						
6.						
7.						
8.						

REMEMBER

How to fill the week columns: write ✓ if it was a problem that week, – if it did not appear, and → if it was better but not gone. “Criteria area” = Reading or Writing.

End-of-course reflection

Do this after Week 4, with all four of your essays in front of you. It matters more than any single session, because it is where you decide what to take into the real assessment.

Compare your four essays

You can ask the AI to help but do the thinking yourself.

PROMPT — copy and paste this into the AI

I am going to paste four essays I wrote over four weeks, on different topics. Comparing them as a set, tell me: what has clearly improved from the first to the last, and what weakness still appears in the most recent essay? Point to evidence. Essay 1: [PASTE] Essay 2: [PASTE] Essay 3: [PASTE] Essay 4: [PASTE]

The biggest improvement across my four essays:

The problem that is most persistent — my priority for the assessment:

Three things I will do in the assessment, where I will have no AI and no teacher: